# NYT Daily Briefing — 2026-10-14

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tl;dr: The United States gave Russia sanctions relief on diesel and called for a new Ukrainian leader. The next night, Russia killed 22 people in Zaporizhzhia. Two nights running, Ukraine got no air-raid warning from its partners. Moscow restated that it will not negotiate. Meanwhile the bond market's term premium hit a decade high, and home-insurance premiums are up 46 percent since 2021. Senate Republicans have now ceded three House districts. And Pope Leo was diagnosed with lung cancer during surgery.

## Cluster 1: Geopolitics & International Affairs

Thematic hook: Washington is repricing the security guarantee it wrote — and the bill is landing on Kyiv, London, Paris and Riyadh at once.

Articles: #4, #5, #6, #13, #14, #15, #16, #17, #18, #19, #20, #21, #22, #46, #66

Trump Hands Victories to Putin, Who Offers More War in Return (#5): President Trump offered sanctions relief for Russian diesel, publicly called for Ukraine to get a new leader, and pressured Kyiv to stop the refinery-strike campaign that had "damaged the Russian economy." Minutes later the Kremlin reiterated that Putin "would not negotiate with Ukraine at the moment." The next day Russia struck Zaporizhzhia, killing 22 people including four children. Moscow has signaled it will escalate further, targeting Ukraine's power and water infrastructure ahead of what Ukrainians expect to be the worst winter of the war.

Ukraine Says It Received No Intelligence About Strikes 2 Nights in a Row (#15): Ukraine reported no warning from Western partners before two consecutive nights of Russian missile attacks on Kyiv. Zelensky's response was blunt: "Once again, no warning from our partners." Both U.S. and Ukrainian officials insisted intelligence sharing continued, and some experts attributed the silence to a weapon type that escaped detection. Either way, Ukraine can no longer know whether its protector is protecting it — and uncertainty about a guarantee degrades the guarantee.

U.K. and Europe Recoil From Trump's Diesel Deal With Putin (#20): European allies denounced the sanctions relief as a gift to Moscow that undercuts the coalition they have paid heavily to sustain. The recoil is diplomatically loud and materially thin. It is the response of parties discovering that their security depends on a patron who has just repriced it.

MI5 Chief Warns of Escalating Hybrid Threats From Iran and Russia on British Soil (#14): MI5's Ken McCallum attributed a spring wave of arson and sabotage against Jewish communities to Iran and called the attacks "sickening." He flagged a shift toward "harder targets, like military sites," plus more than 50 Iran-linked arrests in Britain in twelve months. Russia, he said, "remains aggressor No. 1." London's structural problem is that you cannot garrison every synagogue.

Saudi Energy Giant Struck as War Spikes Between Houthis and Saudi Arabia (#13): An Aramco building in Dhahran was set ablaze after the Houthis threatened the company's headquarters; the Saudi-led coalition reported intercepting four cruise missiles and two drones. **War Collides With Saudi Ambition at a Gathering of Oil Powers (#46):** missile strikes on Riyadh's King Khalid airport killed at least 17 and suspended commercial operations, and the CEOs of Exxon, Shell, Chevron and BP cancelled appearances at the city's energy congress. Energy minister Prince Abdulaziz bin Salman told the hall: "The word 'fear' in the Saudi dictionary does not exist."

Macron Dreamed of Reviving France, but His Term Is Ending in Crisis (#6): With seven months left in office, Macron has failed to resolve the fiscal and welfare problems he promised in 2017 to fix. Police counted 160,000 demonstrators across France in a fourth week of protests over schools and staffing. Analyst Jérôme Fourquet said Macron may be remembered as "the last captain of the boat." A cyberattack disabling refrigeration systems at hundreds of French supermarkets (#21) and the jailing of a Turkish comic for a joke (#22) round out a European picture of eroding institutional slack.

Prediction: Russia will conduct at least one further mass strike on Ukrainian power or water infrastructure before Dec. 31, 2026.

*(Rationale: three consecutive war winters have each featured systematic energy-infrastructure campaigns; #5 reports Russia has "signaled that he plans to escalate further" and describes Ukraine as "sorely lacking air-defense missiles.")* **Confidence: 88%** (near-certain)

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## Cluster 2: US Politics & Domestic Policy

Thematic hook: Three weeks out, both parties are managing the frame and triaging the map — and the distortions are becoming literal.

Articles: #1, #7, #9, #23, #24, #25, #26, #27, #28, #31, #32, #33, #34, #35, #36, #37, #41, #44, #65

Top G.O.P. Groups Pull Support From First House Incumbents (#25): Two super PACs aligned with Trump and congressional leadership cancelled all remaining advertising for Representative Thomas H. Kean Jr. of New Jersey and Representative Mariannette Miller-Meeks of Iowa, after internal polling showed their odds dimming. Having already withdrawn from retiring Representative Don Bacon's Nebraska seat, national Republicans "have now essentially ceded three House districts the party currently holds." They also dropped funds reserved for attacking Democrats Greg Landsman of Ohio and Kristen McDonald Rivet of Michigan. That weekend of triage is the most reliable tell available that internal numbers are worse than public ones.

Democrats Tie Corruption to High Costs in Final Midterms Push (#24): Because their research shows voters have grown "numb" to generic trust appeals, Democrats moved to a causal story: corruption raises your prices. Senator Jon Ossoff tells voters: "Corruption is why things don't work for the American people." The shift from moral appeal to material accounting is what a party does when it must convert an unmotivated base late.

The New Affordability Fight in the Midterms: Home Insurance Prices (#7): Home-insurance premiums have climbed 46 percent since 2021, nearly triple the rate of inflation, driven by climate-worsened fires, hurricanes and tornadoes. One survey found 58 percent of Americans say rising insurance costs make them more likely to vote. Nearly a third of North Carolinians and more than a quarter of Kansans said they postponed major purchases or life decisions. Climate cost now arrives as a monthly bill, and it is putting Kansas and Florida in play.

Kimberly Guilfoyle Resigns as Ambassador to Greece (#1): The White House asked Guilfoyle to quit after reports she asked a Republican donor to wire her $100,000 to pay off a credit card, promising to be his "ride or die in Trump world." Press secretary Katie Zacharia announced the outcome — "We have asked Ambassador Guilfoyle to resign. She has been a wonderful asset to the team, and we wish her well" — and Trump distanced himself: "She wasn't a member of my family." **Katie Zacharia Stepped to the Lectern for the First Time. It Was a Bumpy Ride. (#31)** covers the debut briefing that carried the news.

They Pushed an Anti-Abortion Pill Law. Now, They're Being Sued Under It. (#28): Students for Life helped pass Texas HB 7, which lets nearly anyone sue a pill provider for at least $100,000, with a safe harbor for a woman obtaining pills for herself. A Texas mother is now suing the group for $459,782, arguing its members were not pregnant and so fall inside the law's reach. The statute worked exactly as written.

Supreme Court to Review Dispute Over Access to DOGE Records (#23): The justices agreed to decide whether the Department of Government Efficiency must answer public-records requests, or whether it can claim the privacy of a presidential advisory group. DOGE is long dissolved and Musk long departed, yet the litigation outlives both — the cost of leaving a state's functions and its obligations separable. **Judge Prohibits Further Tree Cutting at East Potomac Golf Course for Two Weeks (#32)** and **American Woman Who Is Accused of Joining ISIS Goes on Trial (#37)** sit in the same institutional-pressure frame.

He Would Be Florida's First Black Governor. Can He Sway Black Voters? (#26): Congressman Byron Donalds is courting Black Floridians against Democratic nominee David Jolly while his party braces for low turnout among Trump's 2024 coalition. One convert, Drumene Woodside, 53, said he was persuaded that Donalds was on the ballot rather than Trump — the source of his party's worry. **El-Sayed, Releasing His Platform on A.I., Calls It an 'Existential Crisis' (#27):** the Michigan Democrat called for a ban on

superintelligent AI and on recursive self-improvement, grounding his position in voter conversations: "this is the existential crisis of our time." His Republican opponent, Mike Rogers, also vows regulation, but from a national-security premise.

Prediction: At least one additional Republican-held House district will have national party advertising withdrawn before Nov. 3, 2026. *(Rationale: three held districts were ceded in roughly one week on internal polling #25; triage decisions of this type have historically been sequential, with each round revealing worse numbers.)* **Confidence: 70%** (high confidence)

Missing the frame (#33, #34, #9, #35, #36, #41, #44, #65): A Maine ad targeting Susan Collins's opponent aired in Portland, Oregon (#34), and Republicans promoted a false rumor that Texas candidate James Talarico was in Ohio (#33). Data on Collins shows she "often defies Trump but rarely stops him" (#9), while Cait Conley leans on her military résumé against Mike Lawler (#35) and Bruce Blakeman attacks Zohran Mamdani before Hasidic leaders (#36). Opinion pieces by David French on Cornell (#41) and by Angus King and Mark Hertling on military lethality (#44) supply the argument; **Your Politics Questions (#65)** supplies the reader mail.

## Cluster 3: Business, Tech & Economy

Thematic hook: Four prices are moving the same way for the same reason — risk that used to be pooled is being repriced onto individuals.

Articles: #47, #48, #49, #50, #51, #52

The Forces Driving Up Bond Yields Take a Troubling Turn (#48): Beyond inflation and AI-driven growth expectations, analysts now point to the "term premium" — the extra return investors demand for the risk of lending to a government. Last week it reached its highest level in more than a decade, reflecting concern about "mounting government debts, rising deficits and other fiscal challenges around the world." The term premium mechanically lifts Treasury yields, which set the reference rate for mortgages, auto loans and corporate debt. A decade-high reading is the bond market beginning to price sovereign risk in the developed world.

Chip Stocks Tumble on A.I. Spending Fears and Rising Chinese Competition (#49): South Korea's KOSPI fell 5.5 percent in a single session, led by Samsung Electronics and SK Hynix, after Chinese media reported that CXMT had unveiled a memory-chip design breakthrough. Fears of runaway AI spending compounded the supply shock. The Philadelphia Semiconductor Index fell as much as 3 percent before closing down just 0.5 percent — but sits roughly 17 percent below its June peak. That gap, not the single-day move, is the signal: the AI trade has lost momentum while capex continues.

Rising Interest Rates Bite Some Wall St. Banks (#50): JPMorgan Chase earned $15.3 billion, short of the more than $16 billion analysts expected, which the article attributes partly to a drop in debt trading revenue after the Fed's rate increase devalued bond holdings. Wells Fargo took investment losses. Goldman Sachs, by contrast, posted profit up 29 percent and revenue up 23 percent, boosted by underwriting fees including this summer's SpaceX I.P.O. Same macro variable, opposite outcomes, decided by business mix.

I.M.F. Warns Mideast War Will Widen Gap Between Rich and Poor Countries (#47): The fund forecast 3.1 percent growth this year and 3.4 percent in 2027, with inflation rising to 4.7 percent this year and 4.1 percent next — inflation above growth. Chief economist Silvana Tenreyro said: "The economy has been resilient, but that resilience is reaching its limits." The average, the fund noted, "masks a reallocation of growth across economies" — oil-importing, tech-light countries lose.

Apple Introduces HomeView, a $299 Tablet for the Home (#51): Apple unveiled a seven-inch home tablet that recognizes up to six household members, shipping Nov. 13, a month after John Ternus took over from Tim Cook. **Hillary Clinton Steps to the Podcast Mic as Midterms Approach (#52)** extends the same media-consolidation logic into politics.

## Cluster 4: Culture & Society

Thematic hook: Institutions are performing accountability while avoiding its cost — and the ledger of recognition is written by someone other than the person who paid.

Articles: #2, #8, #11, #30, #38, #40, #53, #54, #55, #56, #57, #58, #59, #60, #61, #62, #63, #64

Cornell Bans Fraternity Parties and Adds Sexual Assault Investigators (#2): Cornell banned parties at fraternity houses for the rest of the academic year and will add experienced sexual assault investigators in response to a former student's gang-rape allegations. President Michael I. Kotlikoff wrote: "Cornell must be a place where safety is not an open question," adding, "I am deeply sorry for the harm Jane Doe suffered in 2024." One-third of Cornell students are in Greek life, which is why the measure is sweeping.

Tupac Shakur Murder Conviction Lands Man 40 Years to Life in Prison (#30): Duane Keith Davis, 63, was sentenced to 40 years to life for orchestrating Shakur's 1996 killing — a case resolved nearly thirty years on, without physical evidence or direct witness testimony, largely on the strength of the defendant's own repeated confessions. Judge Carli Kierny told him: "You don't get to take his very life, his whole future from him and just walk away from it." Accountability arrived late; it did not arrive cheaply.

Alex Gibney on 'Musk' and Why a 4-Hour Film Was Necessary (#53): Gibney's account of how tech power became political power is the day's sharpest line on the theme. Silicon Valley moguls, he argues, became "friends and flatterers of this guy who can reward them by taking our tax dollars and giving it to them." His formulation: "They found the anomaly in the matrix, which in the American political system is money."

The Next 'It' Apple Might Be 300 Years Old (#64): and **How Climate Change Is Causing 'the Gentrification of Seafood' (#59)** show nature reasserting older cycles — a revived heirloom variety and prized species pushed north as waters warm. **'The Odyssey' Was Shot on Real Film. This Is the Only Place Left Making It. (#58)** is the clearest case of value preserved by everyone else quitting: the last remaining film-stock plant, and no way to copy that moat quickly.

Obituaries and the delayed ledger (#39, #40, #11): A mathematician waited fifty years for proper credit for her work and has died (#39); RJ Mitte, who played Walter White's son and advocated for disability representation, died at 34 (#40); a 200-year-old unmarked grave was finally fixed (#11).

Also in the day's cultural ledger (#8, #38, #54, #55, #56, #57, #60, #61, #62, #63): A family of great horned owls becomes the Upper West Side's most famous household (#8); a man killed at Six Flags struck other riders during his fall (#38); Fontaines D.C. works out of the darkness (#54); and reviews and features on 'Slam Frank' (#55), the Van Gogh Museum's funding rescue (#56), new songs including Musk's words set to music (#57), the small-plate backlash (#60), Daniel Humm's new restaurant (#61), Broadway's singing-waiter diners (#62), and So Fox's Southern farm-to-table cooking (#63).

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## Cluster 5: Science, Health & Environment

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Thematic hook: Who gets cared for, who gets rescued, and who is finally believed before the window closes.

Articles: #3, #10, #12, #29, #39, #42, #43, #45

Pope Leo Found to Have Lung Cancer During Surgery, Vatican Says (#3): The Vatican disclosed that surgeons removed the lower lobe of the pope's right lung after finding a cancerous nodule, confirming lung adenocarcinoma. The 71-year-old was in the operating room about three hours; the Vatican said "the surgery was successful, and there were no complications" and that he "had a restful night." Cleveland Clinic thoracic surgeon Sudish Murthy said the information so far "seems to indicate he has early-stage lung cancer, which is typically treated with surgery and tends to have a very high survival rate." Audiences are cancelled until Oct. 20.

Calls Show How Confusion Delayed Emergency Response for Christa Pike (#29): After Christa Pike's execution went wrong in Tennessee, the first ambulance call was logged at 8:40 p.m. — and confirming it was not a prank took roughly thirty minutes, because it had not come from the prison's central control and the caller lacked the right security verification. A fraud-prevention control sat on a rescue's critical path.

We Aren't Ready for the New Age of Biological Threats (#42): warns that AI is lowering the barriers to bioweapon development faster than policy can respond. **The Best Thing to Do With a Relative Who Has Alzheimer's (#43)** and **The Path to a 'Good Death' Starts With a Plan (#45)** turn the same attention to care at the end of life.

Prediction: The Federal Reserve will not cut its policy rate at its next scheduled meeting. *(Rationale: the I.M.F. projects inflation of 4.7 percent in 2026 and 4.1 percent in 2027 — both far above the 2 percent target — and #50 reports the Fed's most recent move was an increase; cutting into an accelerating inflation path would be historically rare.)* **Confidence: 85%** (near-certain)

Beyond the medical lens (#10, #12): California's boat-dwelling anchor-outs fear a crackdown that would force them onto land (#10), and NJ Transit and Amtrak riders face detours as the Portal Bridge replacement enters its final phase (#12) — infrastructure and habitability questions that sit alongside the day's care stories.

Geographic Note — What This Edition Does and Does Not See: Coverage concentrates in three theaters: the Russia-Ukraine war and its European spillover, the Saudi-Houthi-Iran axis, and U.S. domestic politics. Africa, Latin America and South Asia appear nowhere in the edition's news pages, while East Asia enters only through a market story (South Korea's KOSPI, #49) and a health item about a Chinese chip report — that is, as a supplier and a competitor rather than as a society. Two readings are possible. The charitable one is that editorial attention tracks genuine conflict intensity and the print edition's tight news hole. The structural one is that the paper's mental map now routes almost all non-Western agency through the two wars, so a country can be legible to readers in proportion to its proximity to Washington or Moscow. The practical effect on a reader is to make the world look like an American-Russian contest with a Gulf appendix — which understates where demographic and economic weight is actually accumulating.

## Prediction Summary Table

| # | Prediction | Confidence | Rationale |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Russia conducts at least one further mass strike on Ukrainian power or water infrastructure before Dec. 31, 2026 | 88% | Three consecutive war winters featured energy-infrastructure campaigns; Russia has publicly signaled escalation and Ukraine is "sorely lacking air-defense missiles" (#5) |
| 2 | At least one additional Republican-held House district has national party advertising withdrawn before Nov. 3, 2026 | 70% | Three held districts ceded in about one week on internal polling (#25); triage decisions tend to be sequential |
| 3 | The Federal Reserve does not cut its policy rate at its next scheduled meeting | 85% | I.M.F. projects inflation at 4.7% (2026) and 4.1% (2027), both far above target; most recent Fed move was an increase (#50) |

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|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | The U.S. Treasury term premium remains above its ten-year average through Dec. 31, 2026 | 75% | Reached a decade high last week on deficits and global fiscal stress (#48); these drivers are slow-moving and not scheduled to reverse |
| 5 | At least one of the two House incumbents whose national party advertising was cancelled (Kean of New Jersey, Miller-Meeks of Iowa) loses on Nov. 3, 2026 | 75% | Parties withdraw funds from incumbents when internal polling shows them trailing; abandonment of sitting members is a strong late-cycle predictor (#25) |

*Prepared from 66 stories across the 2026-10-14 New York Times print edition and homepage, analyzed through 5 persona lenses (Connector, Data Analyst, Philosopher, Strategist, Operator).*

## Observer Commentary

### 翟东升

一、柴油换来的不是油价，是信用的自我注销:

底层逻辑是：这不是一笔柴油交易的问题，是美元体系支撑物的问题。美式全球化走到第三阶段——美国既无力提供安全伞，也无力提供消费锚，只能靠透支自己的信用存量来换取当期政治收益。特朗普给俄罗斯柴油豁免制裁、又公开要求乌克兰换领导人，看起来是油价问题，实质是把"制裁的可信度"这个资产一次性变现。制裁之所以有威力，是因为它具有不可逆的可信承诺；一旦为了选前的油价把它打折，信用就被注销了，而注销之后无法重新充值。这就是主权信用货币的物理天花板：货币的价值来自制度可信度，而不是美联储的操作。

二、期限溢价上升，是市场在给主权信用重新定价:

十年期期限溢价创十年新高，这才是今天头版里最重要的数字。期限溢价衡量的是"借钱给政府这件事本身的额外风险"，它上升意味着市场不再只关心利率路径，开始关心财政的可持续性。这不是通胀问题，是偿付能力问题。我一直说，金融市场是主权变迁的滞后指标，不是领先指标——所以当它终于动了，说明底层的钙化已经持续很久。对美国国债而言，期限溢价抬头会把抵押贷款、企业债、汽车贷款的基准利率一起抬起来，于是"可负担性"从竞选口号变成了资产负债表事实。结构性两难就在这里：美联储不能降息（通胀4.7%），也不能安心维持（债务服务成本）。制度熵增已经进入自我强化的区间。

三、平行体系不是选择，是结果:

欧洲对柴油协议只是"recoil"——口头谴责、行动缺位，因为它既没有独立的安全资产，也没有独立的支付清算能力。MI5点名伊朗、法国超市冷链被网袭、波罗的海无人机——防务的分工已经跟不上威胁的分布。金灿荣说的是格局重排，我看的是基础设施重排：当SWIFT、清算行、保险与再保险这些"金融高边疆"的支柱逐一被政治化，各国不是选择离开美元体系，而是被迫为自己修一条并行通道。真正的信号不在莫斯科，而在于谁在建造清算与结算的替代品，以及谁在被迫使用它。

### 金灿荣

一、今天的头版很有意思:

各位朋友，今天聊一聊10月14号这份纽约时报。你们看啊，头版头条是什么？美国给了俄罗斯柴油制裁豁免，还公开要求乌克兰换领导人；第二天俄罗斯在扎波罗热炸死了22个人，里面有4个孩子。然后呢？克里姆林宫说，暂时不谈判。这个事情其实很简单——你给对手送礼，对手收了礼，然后接着打你。为什么？因为这个礼不是你自愿送的，是你被人逼着送的。

二、什么叫"战略相持"？这就是:

我讲战略三阶段，第一阶段"美攻我守"已经过去了，现在是"战略相持"——互有攻守。你看现在这个局面，非常典型。美国的国内政治需要油价降下来，中期选举快到了；但是俄罗斯那边根本不着急。打仗这个事情，最怕的就是一方为了国内政治而打仗，因为对手很容易看穿你的时间表。美国人现在很焦虑，焦虑到什么程度？连给乌克兰的早期预警都不给了——泽连斯基说"又一次，我们的伙伴没有预警"。你们记不记得，冷战时期美国之所以是西方的头，靠的就是两个东西：安全伞和情报。现在这两个东西都在缩水。

三、欧洲就是一个旁观者:

欧洲的反应是什么？"recoil"，就是嘴上骂两句。为什么？因为它既没有独立的军队，也没有独立的金融。法国总统马克龙在核潜艇甲板上看导弹发射，国内16万人上街游行；德国的能源、英国的金融、法国的财政，哪一个能离开美国？这不是它们不聪明，是结构决定了它们只能当旁观者。

四、结论:

我们看这个百年变局，核心是什么？工业化本体论。谁能把东西造出来，谁就有底气。美国现在的问题是产业空心化——工厂没了，只能靠金融和制裁维持霸权，而金融和制裁这两个工具，用得越多，越不管用。俄乌这一局，加速了欧洲的觉醒，也加速了多极化的进程。

东升西降，这个方向不会变。中国要做的就是把自己的事情做好。

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## 宋鸿兵

一、把今天的头版看成一个系统:

如果你把今天这条新闻看成一个系统，它的核心问题是单点故障。乌克兰的防空体系有一个单点：西方的早期预警数据链。10月13号、14号连续两个夜晚，这个单点断了——没有预警，弹道导弹落到基辅。谁掐断的？没有人承认。这就是控制系统里最危险的状态：故障源不可识别，于是整个系统的稳定性余量被重新估计。我要提醒大家，金融系统也是一样，它的单点是清算。今天法国几百家超市的冷链被网络攻击打掉，明天就可能是清算行。

二、期限溢价：利率风暴的第一声:

十年期美债的期限溢价创十年新高，这是今天最值钱的数字。什么叫期限溢价？就是市场借钱给政府，除了要求利率以外，还要额外收一笔"违约风险费"。这笔费用上升，说明市场开始怀疑的不是通胀，而是偿付能力。美元环流逆转的机制正是这样启动的：当外国央行不再愿意把贸易顺差买回美债，美国只能提高收益率去抢钱；收益率一高，抵押贷款、企业债、保险全部跟着涨。而今天同时出现的另一个数字——房屋保险费自2021年上涨46%——本质上是同一个机制在居民资产负债表上的投影：风险从被分摊，变成了被单独定价。

三、三变六反：我们正处在第二次反转的后半段:

三变六反，凡事不过三。第一次变化是全球化，第一次反转是去全球化；第二次变化是美元霸权，第二次反转就是储备多元化。今天所有的新闻——俄罗斯柴油豁免、胡塞武装打沙特阿美、瑞亚德的能源大会在导弹威胁下开会——都是第二次反转的具体场景。帝国黄昏的特征从来不是打输一场战争，而是用信誉去换现金，换到最后信誉归零，现金也买不到东西。

四、结语:

债务火山不会在一夜之间喷发，它先冒烟——期限溢价就是烟。物以稀为贵乃是投资的天道，而这个年代最稀缺的东西，是可兑现的承诺。

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